

Akhilesh Thite

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Education

University of California Santa Cruz

Masters of Science : Computer Science and Engineering

Sept 2024 - June 2026

Graduate Teaching Assistant CSE 185

Terna Engineering College

Bachelor of Engineering : Computer Engineering

Aug 2019 - June 2023

Work Experience

Founder - PeerSky Browser | P2P Labs

Feb 2022 - Present

- Leading development of **PeerSky Browser**, a peer-to-peer local-first web browser with **2,000+** users enabling resilient, accessible, and user-owned web experiences.
- Manage engineers and mentor open-source contributors, including **Google Summer of Code** contributors, across protocols, apps, UI/UX, and browser architecture.
- Built and shipped core features including local LLM APIs, support for IPFS, Hypercore, and BitTorrent for decentralized publishing, P2P apps, and web extension compatibility, enabling users to access, communicate, and publish without centralized infrastructure.
- Secured **\$20,000+** in grant funding from Protocol Labs and Gitcoin, driving sustainable open-source development.

Mobile Application Engineer Intern - IdentiKey

July 2025 - Aug 2025

- Designed and implemented secure key recovery, P2P onboarding, and verifiable credential flows in a cross-platform React Native app with 4-factor authentication.

Software Developer Intern - okTurtles Foundation

June 2025 - Aug 2025

Worked on **Chelonia**, an end-to-end encrypted, open-source, and federated framework built on **Shelter Protocol**.

- Implemented 'chel serve' by migrating 30,000+ lines of JavaScript to TypeScript across 170+ files, transforming the Chelonia CLI backend to a production-ready developer platform.
- Implemented 'chel pin' contract pinning with per-contract pinning capabilities, enabling independent contract lifecycle management and reducing deployment complexity.
- Built a TodoMVC example demonstrating Chelonia's contract architecture, serving as a reference implementation for developers.
- Modernized codebase infrastructure by migrating to Deno 2.0, implementing ESLint standards, and establishing robust CLI command structure.

Software Engineer - Distributed Systems - hypha.coop

Aug 2023 - Aug 2024

- Worked as part of the **Distributed Press** team to develop and implement features utilizing a **half-million-dollar** grant funded by **FFDW**, enabling Distributed Press-published websites to engage with the expansive Fediverse community, comprising over **10 million+** users across platforms like Mastodon and PixelFed.
- Played a key role in development and implementation of the **Social Inbox**, a pioneering tool that integrates social interaction capabilities into websites on the decentralized web.
- Implemented ActivityPub standards to facilitate follow requests, replies, and content updates, transforming websites into dynamic social profiles.
- Developed **Social Reader**, a P2P and offline ActivityPub client for reading and following microblogs on the Fediverse.
- Developed **DP-CLI**, a command-line tool enabling publishers to manage and publish decentralized websites, and interact with the Fediverse via ActivityPub.

Independent Web3 Developer, Hackathons

Feb 2021 - Jun 2023

- Solo hacker, **8x** Web3 hackathon winnings, **3x** devgrants.

Projects

P2Pmd: A real-time peer-to-peer Markdown editor for writing notes and collaboration, **code**.

PeerChat: A local-first peer-to-peer chat app, **code**.

COVID-19 Vaccine Finder: check the available slots for vaccination centres from coWIN API in India (it was used by **thousands** during the COVID-19 pandemic to find available vaccine slots), **code**.

Skills

Languages: JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, Solidity

Lib/Frameworks: Electron, React, Flask, React Native

Protocols: IPFS, Hypercore, BitTorrent, ActivityPub, Ethereum

Databases: SQLite, MongoDB, IndexedDB

Tools: Git, Node.js, Deno

Awards

- **Apr 2026: Infrastructure & Digital Rights Track Winner, PL Genesis Hackathon** - Received 3rd prize worth **\$1000** for Infrastructure & Digital Rights track for building **P2Pmd**.
- **Mar 2025: First Generation Graduate Research and Travel Award** - Awarded by the University of California, Santa Cruz for academic excellence and research impact as a first-generation graduate student to present work at a conference.
- **Mar 2025: People's Choice Speaker** - Awarded the Peoples Choice Speaker at ETHDenver, a community-nominated honor recognizing top voices from over **2,000+** submissions.
- **Oct 2024: Center For Research in Open Source Software (CROSS) Prize** - Peersky Browser was awarded **\$500** in the Open Source Track at the UCSC Ideathon.
- **Sep 2024: GitHub Universe Scholarship** - Awarded a complimentary General Admission ticket valued at **\$1300** to attend GitHub Universe 2024.
- **Jun 2023: Global DWeb Fellow & Speaker** - Awarded the DWeb **fellowship** for **DWeb Camp 2023**. Recognized as one of the **youngest** fellows in the cohort.
- **Apr 2023: IPFS Community Impact Awards Q2'23** - DScan Extension was **recognized** at the **IPFS Thing** event in Brussels as a recipient of an IPFS Community Impact Award.
- **Feb 2023: Mantle Mash Hackathon Winner** - Won a bounty worth **\$2500** for the Developer Infrastructure & Tooling track.
- **Oct 2022: IPFS Scholar** - Awarded the IPFS Scholarship in recognition of significant contributions to the IPFS ecosystem, enabling attendance and knowledge sharing at IPFS Camp 2022 in Lisbon, Portugal.
- **Mar 2022: Across the Line Award Faber Web3 Hackathon** - Received runner-up award worth **\$1000** for the Filecoin & IPFS track. Built the **DHost** VS Code Extension.
- **Nov 2021: MARS Asia Hackathon 2nd Prize** - Received 2nd prize worth **\$5000** for the Filecoin & IPFS Decentralization track. Developed the **DScan** Chrome extension.
- **Nov 2021: Polygon BUIDL IT Hackathon Runner-Up** - Achieved Top 40 on Polygon worth **\$500** and Top 20 on Filecoin & IPFS worth **\$250**. Created an **NFT ticketing** marketplace on the Polygon Blockchain.
- **Aug 2021: Polygon Learn Tutorial Reward** - Received a reward worth **\$1000** for writing the educational articles on Polygon.
- **Aug 2021: ETHOdyssey Hackathon 3rd Prize** - Secured 3rd prize worth **\$500** for the Filecoin & IPFS track. Developed **DTube**, a decentralized video sharing & social media platform on the Ethereum blockchain.
- **Feb 2021: IPFS Bounty Winner at ETHDenver Hackathon** - Won a **\$100** IPFS bounty for our project focused on AI-generated NFTs on the Ethereum blockchain.
- **Aug 2020 - Apr 2021: Notebooks Expert - Kaggle** - Achieved the highest rank of **1232** out of 300,000+ participants with 1 gold, 1 silver, and 3 bronze medals for notebooks, accumulating over **37,000+** views.